

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. A right becomes real only when its procedure is usable.
2. Public trust grows through small acts of reliability.
3. Technology should reduce distance, not responsibility.
4. The habit of revision is a sign of strength.

Marking guidance: Marking rubric: relevance and qualified thesis 20; organisation 20; analysis, examples and balance 25; grammar and vocabulary 25; conclusion and approximate 600-word limit 10.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

A public service may be legally available and still remain practically inaccessible. Eligibility rules can be generous while application forms are obscure, offices distant and correction procedures uncertain. In such cases the gap is not between law and complete inaction but between a declared entitlement and a usable route to obtain it. Simplification does not mean removing every check. Verification protects public resources and prevents fraud, but a check should be proportionate to the risk it addresses. Requiring the same document repeatedly from citizens whose information is already held by government shifts administrative failure onto the applicant. Digital services can reduce travel and delay, yet they may create new exclusion when identity matching fails or assistance is unavailable. A sound system therefore provides multiple channels, explains adverse decisions and permits timely appeal. Its success should be measured not merely by applications processed but by whether eligible people receive the service without unreasonable cost, uncertainty or loss of dignity.

1. How can a legally available service remain inaccessible?

Model answer: Obscure forms, distant offices, repeated documentation and uncertain correction procedures can make the entitlement unusable.

2. Why should verification be proportionate?

Model answer: Checks are legitimate only to the extent needed to address risk; excessive demands transfer administrative burdens to citizens.

3. How can digitisation both include and exclude?

Model answer: It reduces travel and delay but can exclude users through failed identity matching, limited access or absent assistance.

4. What procedural safeguards does the author recommend?

Model answer: Multiple access channels, reasons for adverse decisions and a timely appeal or correction route.

5. What measure of success does the passage prefer?

Model answer: Whether eligible people actually receive the service without unreasonable cost, uncertainty or indignity.

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Expertise is essential in complex administration, but it can create distance between those who design a policy and those who experience it. Specialists know technical constraints and can protect decisions from popular error. Yet professional language may hide assumptions that ordinary users would immediately question. Consultation is therefore not a substitute for expertise; it is a test of whether expertise has understood the problem. Weak consultation merely asks for comments after the main choices are fixed. Better consultation identifies affected groups early, explains alternatives in accessible language and records why major objections were accepted or rejected. Participation cannot mean that every preference becomes policy. Interests conflict, resources are limited and elected institutions must decide. Its value lies in improving evidence, exposing unintended consequences and making reasons visible. Experts remain responsible for technical quality, while decision-makers remain

accountable for the values and trade-offs embodied in the final choice.

Model answer: Expertise protects complex decisions but may overlook assumptions visible to users. Consultation should therefore test, not replace, professional judgment. Meaningful participation begins early, explains alternatives and records responses to objections. It cannot satisfy every preference, but it improves evidence, reveals unintended effects and clarifies reasons. Experts retain technical responsibility and public authorities remain accountable for final trade-offs.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. Each of the reports contain an annexure.

Answer: Each of the reports contains an annexure.

2. The committee comprises of five members.

Answer: The committee comprises five members.

3. She is senior than me.

Answer: She is senior to me.

4. The news are encouraging.

Answer: The news is encouraging.

5. He prevented me to enter.

Answer: He prevented me from entering.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. conform ____

Answer: to

2. deprive ____

Answer: of

3. prefer X ____

Answer: to Y

4. refrain ____

Answer: from

5. eligible ____

Answer: for

C. Use the correct verb form

1. When I reached, they ____ (leave).

Answer: had left

2. If I ____ (be) you, I would appeal.

Answer: were

3. The files ____ (verify) now.

Answer: are being verified

4. She usually ____ (travel) by bus.

Answer: travels

5. They ____ (work) since dawn.

Answer: have been working

D. Choose the correct word

1. adverse/averse

Answer: adverse

2. ensure/insure

Answer: ensure

3. council/counsel

Answer: counsel

4. imply/infer

Answer: infer

5. economic/economical

Answer: economical

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS